

Mini Design Sprint Report – Silka App

1 Introduction

This report describes a mini design sprint for the Silka mobile app. Silka is a discreet safety app for women in abusive or controlling environments. It is disguised as a weather app to reduce suspicion.

The sprint focused on improving one key part of the user experience: hidden emergency activation.

2 Design Challenge

The selected design challenge was:

How can a user request help quickly without making the situation suspicious?

This was important because the app must protect the user without exposing its real purpose.

3 Sprint Process

The sprint was completed in three phases.

Phase 1 – Define the Problem

The focus was hidden emergency activation.

Success criteria:

- The app should look like a normal weather app
- The trigger should be quick to use
- Accidental activation should be avoided
- The interface should remain simple
- The user should feel safe and in control

Phase 2 – Explore Solutions

Several ideas were considered:

- Text trigger through the weather search bar
- Voice trigger word
- Hidden access word for settings
- Countdown before escalation

- Neutral wording instead of obvious emergency labels.

Phase 3 – Prototype and Test

The prototype was tested with users.

The testing focused on:

- First impression of the weather disguise
- Ease of finding and using the trigger
- Clarity of the setup flow
- Trust in the app's privacy

4 Findings

The weather disguise worked well because it looked natural and did not reveal the app's purpose. Users understood the idea after a short explanation.

The main improvement area was setup navigation. Some parts needed clearer wording so users could configure the app more confidently.

The testing also showed that privacy is a major concern. Users wanted reassurance that sensitive information stays protected.

5 Conclusion

The sprint confirmed that a disguised interface is a suitable direction for Silka. It also showed that hidden safety features must be simple, reliable, and easy to configure.

The feedback helped identify practical improvements for the next development stage.

6 Next Development Steps

- Improve the settings flow
- Add personalized voice activation and activation while phone is locked
- Support multiple trusted contacts
- Continue user testing with more participants and edge cases.

7 Reflection

This sprint helped me test an important part of Silka before adding more features. It showed that early feedback is useful, especially for a sensitive safety project where trust, clarity, and discretion are essential.